

The Night Train to Sleepy Hollow

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Molly the little mouse was tucked into bed. Her blanket was warm. Her pillow was fluffy. But her eyes would not close. She felt restless and wide awake.

Then she heard it. A soft sound came through her window. Chugga-chugga. Chugga-chugga. It was a tiny train rolling past her house.

Molly peeked out. The train was small and silver. It glowed with warm, golden light. A friendly old tortoise leaned out of the window. He wore a tall conductor hat.



"All aboard the Yawn Express!" he called. "Next stop, Sleepy Hollow!"

Molly felt curious. "Can I come?" she asked. "I cannot fall asleep."

"Climb aboard, little one," said the conductor. "This train carries sleepy travelers."

Molly hopped onto the train in her pajamas. The seats were made of soft pillows. The conductor gave her a warm milk ticket. He punched it with a tiny click.

"Chugga-chugga, hush, hush, hush," sang the train.



The train rolled past Pillow Plains. The hills there were soft and white. It rolled past Blanket Bay. The waves were made of folded quilts. Molly felt her eyelids growing heavy.

"Chugga-chugga, hush, hush, hush," sang the train again.

A sleepy owl waved from a lamppost. A drowsy rabbit yawned at a crossing. Everyone along the track was going to sleep. Molly yawned a great big yawn. She felt calm and drowsy.



"Chugga-chugga, hush, hush, hush," sang the train one more time.

At last the train slowed down. A wooden sign read SLEEPY HOLLOW. The station was quiet and dark. Stars twinkled over the platform like tiny lamps.

"This is your stop," whispered the conductor. "Sweet dreams, little traveler."

Molly climbed down from the train. She was already half asleep. She curled up on a bench made of clouds. The conductor tucked a starlight blanket around her.



The train rolled softly away into the night. Molly's breathing grew slow and deep. Her whiskers stopped twitching. She felt safe and sleepy.

Drift off now, little mouse. The Yawn Express will carry you to the softest dreams.

Moral: Rest can be a gentle journey, and it is okay to let it carry you.

The End